Requesting Time Off - SOP

1. Purpose

This SOP (Standard Operating Procedure) explains how to request time off with the Time Off Request form, how your request is approved, and how you are notified about your PTO (Paid Time Off) balance and new PTO grants.

2. Key terms

Term	Meaning
PTO (Paid Time Off)	Paid days off that come out of your balance.
Balance	PTO days you have today.
Available balance	Your balance minus time off already approved for future dates. This is what you can still request.
Grant	PTO days added to your balance by the policy on a set date (see section 3).
Banked day	An approved extra day you worked (for example, a weekend) that is added to your balance as PTO.
Flex time / Day swap	A day off that you make up by working other hours or another day. It does not use PTO.
Approver	The person who approves or denies requests: Management.
PTO Administrator	The person who maintains the PTO records: Angel Pabuence, Data Analyst.

3. How you earn PTO

PTO is granted in lump sums based on your hire date. After the first grant, you receive a grant every 6 months, on your hire anniversary and half-anniversary.

When	Days granted
4 months after hire (one time)	2 days
6 months and 1 year	5 days each
1.5 and 2 years	6 days each
2.5 and 3 years	7 days each
3.5 and 4 years	8 days each
4.5 and 5 years	9 days each

When	Days granted
5.5 and 6 years	10 days each
After 6 years	10 days every 6 months

Grants are added automatically. On the morning of your grant date, the system adds the days to your balance and sends you an email with the days added and your new balance. You do not need to request them. Your balance cannot go above 20 days: if a grant would take you above 20, only the days up to 20 are added. You never lose days you already have.



Figure 1. Example of the automatic grant email ("PTO grant added")

4. Before you submit

- Submit **one request per time-off period**. Consecutive days go in one request with a start date and an end date.
- Count **workdays only**. Do not count weekends or federal holidays (the offices are closed, so those days never use PTO).
- Submit as early as possible, so the approver has time to decide and plan coverage.
- If your plans are not final, wait. A request is approved for the exact dates you enter.
- Not sure about your balance? Check your last PTO email or ask the PTO Administrator.

5. Submitting a request

5.1 Open the form

1. Open the **Time Off Request** form: Time Off Request - Office Staff. – Fill out form (link).
2. Sign in with your Right at Home Microsoft account if asked.

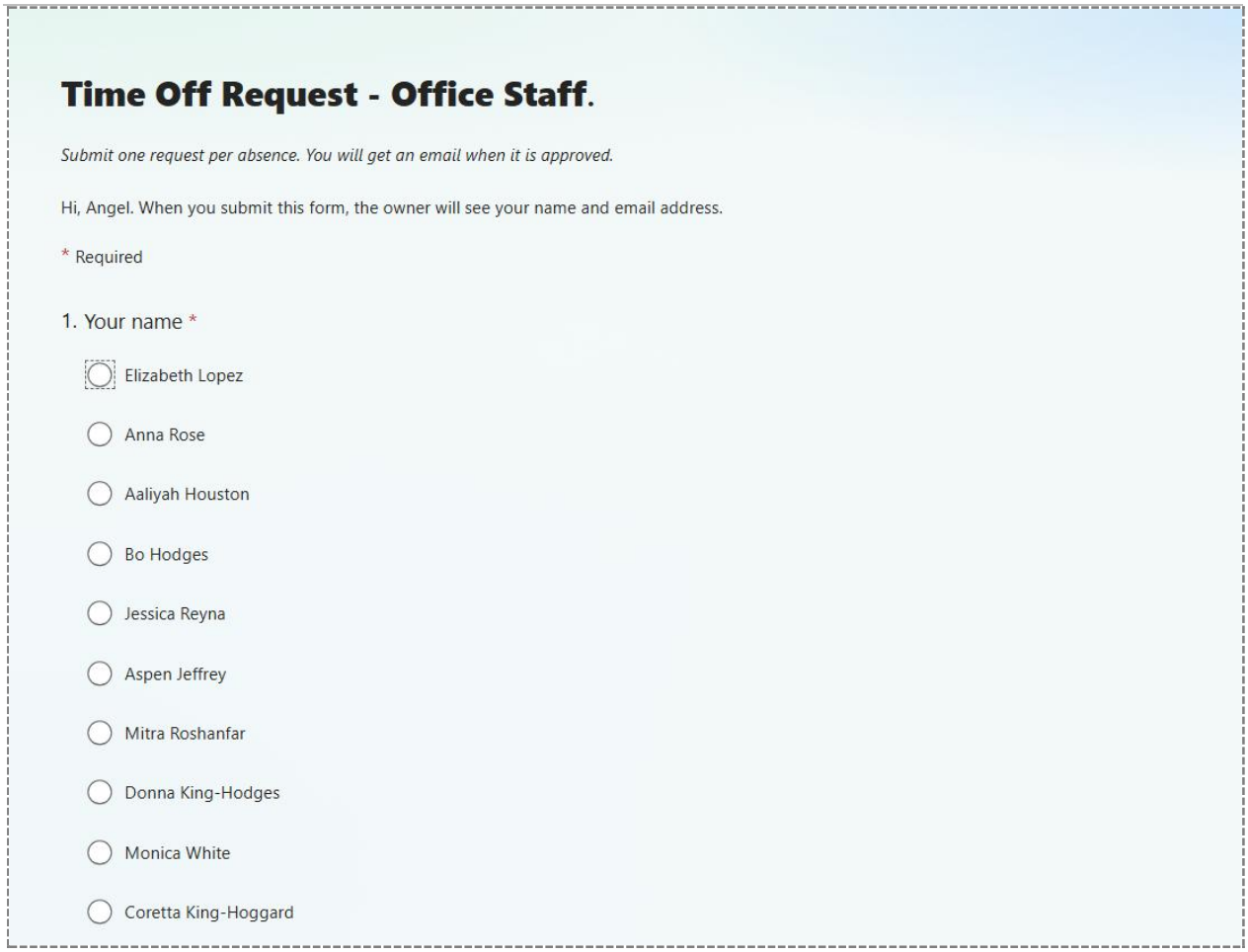


Figure 2. Time Off Request form – first screen

5.2 Your name and type of request

1. **Your name:** choose your name from the list. If your name is missing, do not choose another name; contact the PTO Administrator.
2. **Type of request:** choose the option that matches your time off (see the table below).

Option in the form	Use it when…	Effect on your PTO balance
Paid Time Off (PTO)	You want a paid day off from your balance.	Subtracts the days
Flex time (make up the hours)	You take time off and make up the hours on other days.	No change
Extra day worked - bank as PTO	You worked an approved extra day and want it added to your balance.	Adds the days
Extra day worked - take another day off	You worked an extra day and will take a different day off instead.	No change

Option in the form	Use it when…	Effect on your PTO balance
Unpaid time off	You need time off without pay.	No change
Bereavement	Time off for a death in the family.	No change
Jury duty	You were called for jury duty.	No change



Figure 3. Your name and Type of request questions

5.3 Extra question (only for some options)

- **Flex time:** the form asks "How will you make up the hours?" Write the days and hours you will work.
- **Extra day worked - take another day off:** the form asks "Which day will you take off instead?" Write the date.

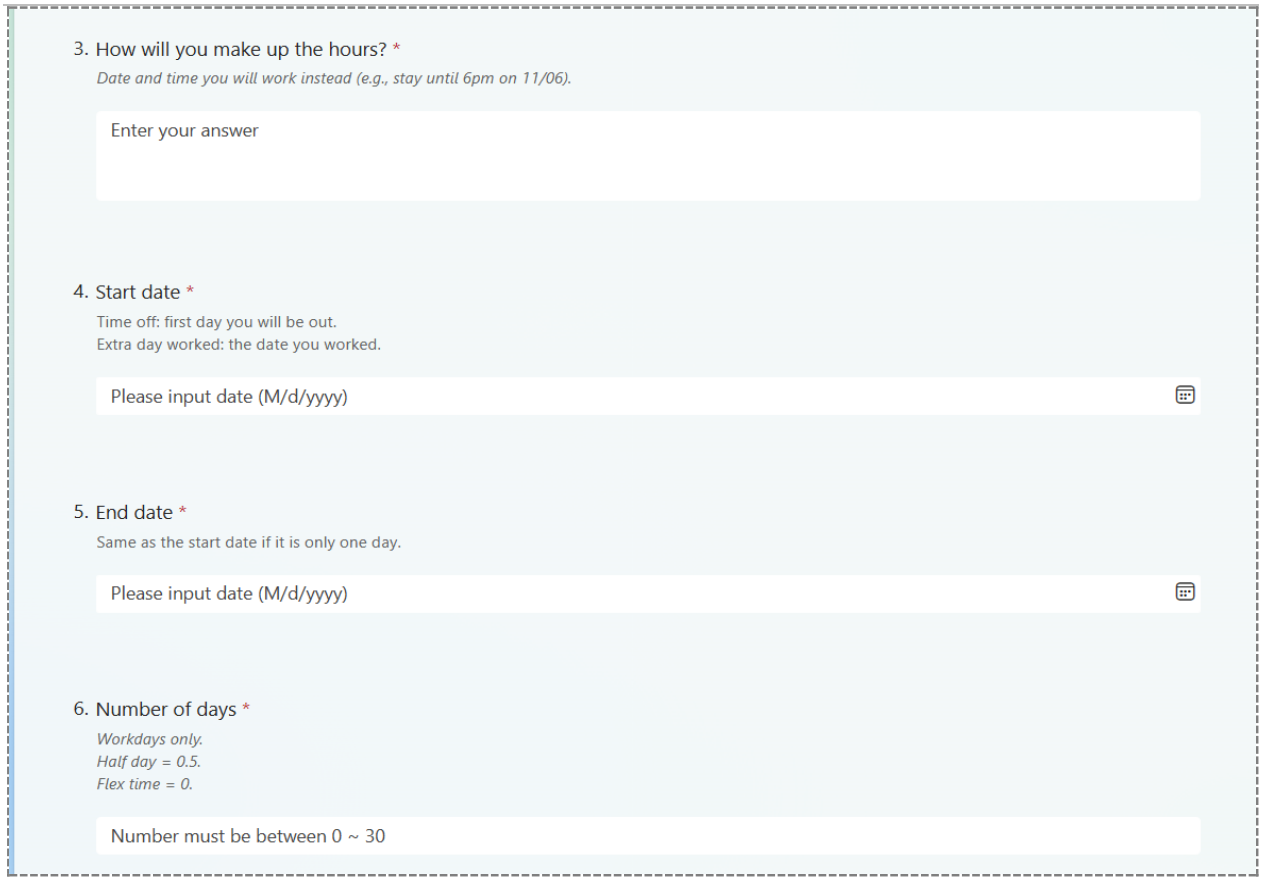


Figure 4. Extra question for Flex time or for taking another day off

5.4 Dates, days and notes

1. **Start date:** your first day off (or the extra day you worked).
2. **End date:** your last day off. For one day, use the same date as the start date.
3. **Number of days:** the workdays in that period. Whole days only – half days are not used.
4. **Notes (optional):** anything the approver should know (for example, "doctor appointment in the morning").
5. Click **Submit**.

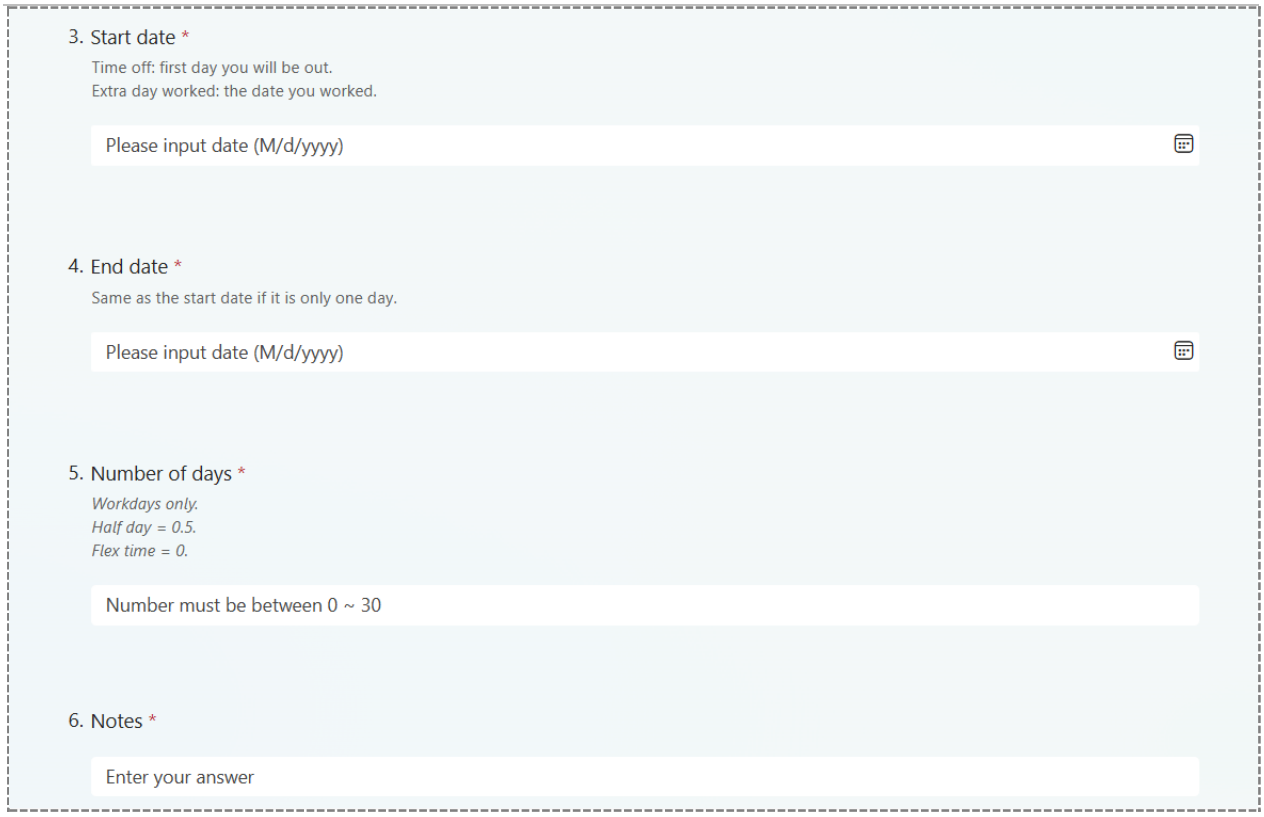


Figure 5. Start date, End date, Number of days and Notes

6. What happens after you submit

1. Your request is recorded with a request ID (for example, MF-25).
2. **Not enough PTO:** if you request more PTO days than you have available, you receive an email right away telling you how many days will be paid and how many will be unpaid. To change or cancel the request, contact Management before it is approved.
3. The approver receives it in Outlook with your available balance and the balance you would have after the request.
4. The approver approves or denies it.
5. **Approved:** you receive an email with the dates, the days and your remaining balance. The time off is recorded automatically. If part of the request is unpaid, the email shows the paid and unpaid days, and payroll is notified.
6. **Denied:** you receive an email with the approver's comments. If they ask you to correct something, submit a new request.

Note: Do not take time off until you receive the approval email. If you have not heard back within a few business days, contact the approver.

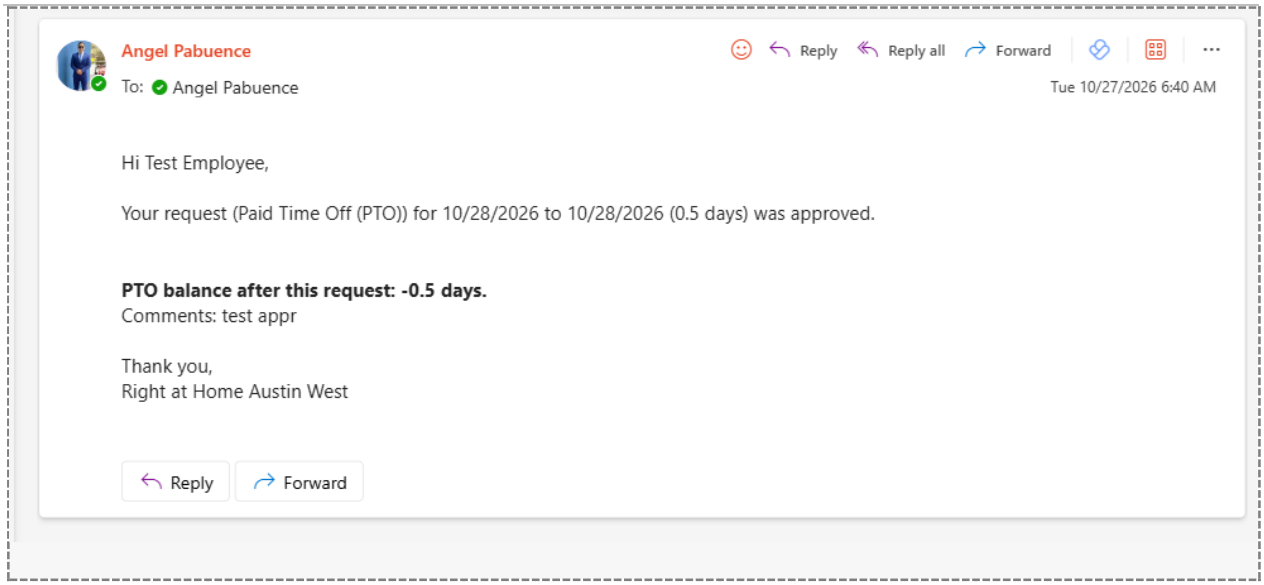


Figure 6. Example of an approval email (request approved, with balance left)

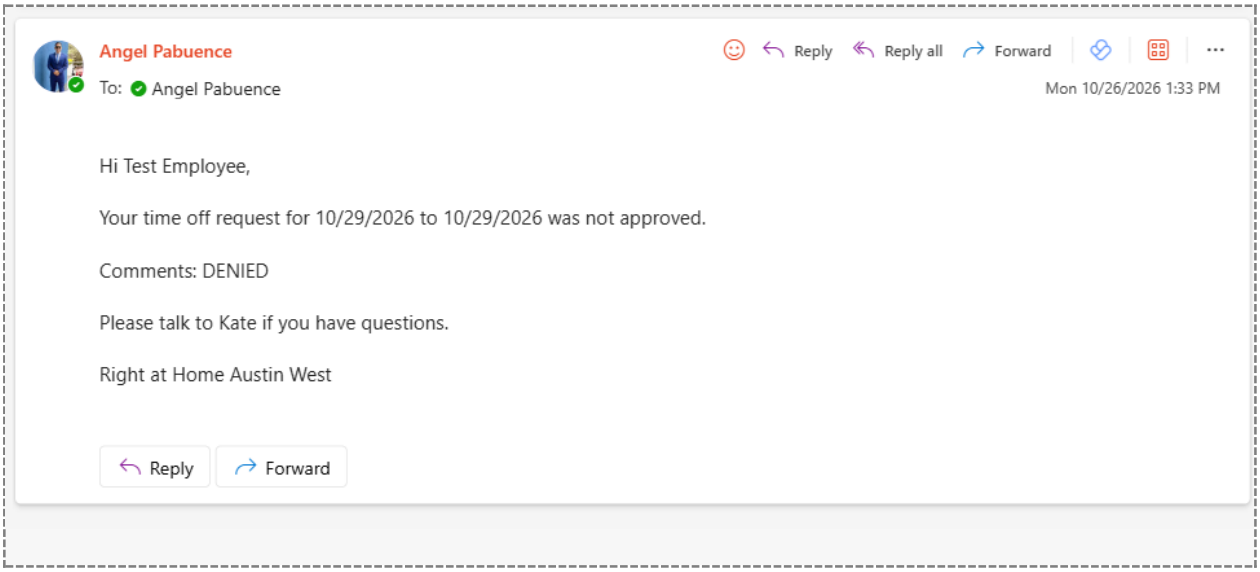


Figure 7. Example of a denial email (with approver comments)

7. Changes and mistakes

Never submit a second request to "fix" a first one. Duplicates cause confusion. Use the table below.

Situation	What to do
I made a mistake and the request is **not decided yet**	Tell the approver. They will deny it with a comment, and you submit a new, correct request.
I submitted the same request twice	Tell the approver. They will approve one and deny the other as "Duplicate".

Situation	What to do
My request was **approved**, but I am no longer taking the time off	Email the approver and the PTO Administrator before the date. The days will be returned to your balance.
I took fewer or more days than approved	Email the PTO Administrator with the request ID and the correct number of days. Your balance will be corrected.
I did not receive an email after submitting	Contact the PTO Administrator. Do not submit again.
My name is not in the list	Contact the PTO Administrator.
My balance looks wrong	Contact the PTO Administrator. You can ask for a statement with your full PTO history.

8. Frequently asked questions

Can my balance go negative? Only if Management approves borrowing PTO from your next grant (an advance). The negative days are paid back by your next grant. Otherwise, days beyond your PTO balance are unpaid.

How do I see my balance? Every approval and grant email shows it. For a full statement, ask the PTO Administrator.

I worked a weekend. How do I get the day? Submit a request with "Extra day worked - bank as PTO" (to add it to your balance) or "Extra day worked - take another day off" (to swap it for another day).

Does unpaid time off, bereavement or jury duty use my PTO? No. They are recorded, but your balance does not change.

Can I take half a day of PTO? No. PTO is counted in whole days only.

Is unused PTO paid out when I leave? No. Unused PTO is not paid out. If you leave on good terms, Management may let you use your remaining PTO before your last day.